

need in gynaecological cancers in India and represent meaningful progress in women's cancer care," says Bhushan Akshikar, Managing Director, GSK India. Jemperli targets advanced endometrial cancer, while Zejula is for ovarian cancer. "GSK is participating in clinical trials in India to explore the potential of Dostarlimab in treating other cancers," says the spokesperson.

Lupin is also prioritising oncology. "Affordability continues to be a major hurdle in cancer treatment. We are working to balance accessibility with business sustainability by focusing on complex generics and biosimilars. These alternatives to branded drugs are typically priced lower, which helps reduce costs for patients without compromising on treatment quality," says Rajeev Sibal, President-India Region Formulations at Lupin.

38 | Lupin's strategy involves delivering treatments at scale with competitive pricing and reaching a broader patient base rather than relying predominantly on high-margin products. Sibal emphasises the importance of partnerships and patient support programmes in enhancing treatment availability. "Collaboration is vital, particularly in reaching underserved regions," he says.

The company is also investing in cancer research. "India's diverse population and strong manufacturing capabilities provide a unique advantage for clinical trials and drug development, especially in complex fields like oncology," says Sibal. The company has launched biosimilars like Lupifil and Lupifil-P, which support patients on chemotherapy by boosting neutrophil counts. The company is also advancing its pipeline with treatments involving Nivolumab and Pembrolizumab,

WHY TREATMENT COSTS A BOMB IN INDIA

**PET-CT
SCANNER**

**₹3.3
CRORE**

**LINEAR
ACCELERATOR
(LINAC)**

**₹5.2
CRORE**

**THERAPY
COSTS**

**₹1-27
LAKH**

Depending on
Type/Stage

**PROTON THERAPY
CENTRE (APOLLO,
CHENNAI)**

**₹1,300
CRORE**



among others. "Our focus remains on building a comprehensive portfolio that addresses various cancer types," says Sibal. Lupin is also enhancing its digital health solutions to improve patient outcomes and explore new opportunities globally.

Glenn Saldanha, Chairman and Managing Director of Glenmark Pharmaceuticals Ltd, says the company is working on immunology medicines, antibody-drug conjugates, and multispecific antibodies, including trispecifics. One such candidate, ISB 2001—its first-in-class trispecific for multiple myeloma—illustrates how innovation could create new treatment pathways in difficult-to-treat cancers.

Saldanha says supportive government policies are crucial for



"We have expanded programmes in haematology and bone marrow transplantation and now plan to set up oncology and haematology centres of excellence"

**ASHUTOSH
RAGHUVANSHI**
MD & CEO, FORTIS
HEALTHCARE